



## QMS-005 — Supplier and Contractor Evaluation Policy

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### 1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This policy sets out how Overleaf Publishers Ltd selects, approves, monitors, and reviews suppliers and contractors to ensure that externally provided services and products consistently meet quality, safety, and security requirements. It applies to all third-party providers of goods and services that could affect the quality of the Chainsaw Courses platform, learner safety, or data security. Document reference: QMS-005.

### 2. SUPPLIER CATEGORIES

| CATEGORY (RISK LEVEL)                                                            | EXAMPLES                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Platform and infrastructure (High — direct impact on availability and security)  | Replit (hosting), Vimeo (video), payment gateways |
| AI and data processing (High — affects content quality and data security)        | OpenAI via Replit proxy                           |
| Content and subject matter (High — affects safety-critical content accuracy)     | NPTC/SME contractors, technical reviewers         |
| Print and fulfilment (Medium — affects product quality and packaging compliance) | Manual printers, postal fulfilment                |
| Professional services (Medium — affects compliance and data handling)            | Accountants, legal advisers, IT support           |
| Utilities and office supplies (Low — minimal direct product quality impact)      | Energy, stationery, telecoms                      |

### 3. SUPPLIER APPROVAL PROCESS

No new supplier or contractor may be engaged until the approval process is complete. Steps:

| STEP                        | ACTION                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 — Identify need           | Director identifies requirement and defines specification for the required product/service.                                                                                                                  |
| 2 — Supplier identification | Minimum of two potential suppliers identified and assessed where possible.                                                                                                                                   |
| 3 — Pre-qualification       | Supplier completes pre-qualification questionnaire covering: capability, quality management, information security, H&S, environmental policy, and relevant insurance.                                        |
| 4 — Verification            | Director verifies: public liability insurance ("e£1M); relevant professional qualifications/certifications; financial stability indicators; references (for high-risk suppliers); and regulatory compliance. |
| 5 — Risk assessment         | Supplier risk assessed and classification assigned (see Section 2).                                                                                                                                          |



|                             |                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>6 — Approval</b>         | Director approves supplier for engagement. Approved Supplier Register updated.                                                    |
| <b>7 — Contract / order</b> | Written contract or purchase order issued, including quality, security, and H&S requirements as appropriate to the risk category. |

#### 4. SUPPLIER PERFORMANCE MONITORING

Ongoing monitoring is proportionate to supplier risk category:

| SUPPLIER TYPE                                      | MONITORING FREQUENCY AND METHOD                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>High-risk suppliers (platform, AI, content)</b> | Quarterly performance review; SLA compliance check; annual formal evaluation |
| <b>Medium-risk suppliers</b>                       | Annual performance review; issue-triggered review as required                |
| <b>Low-risk suppliers</b>                          | Biennial review or issue-triggered                                           |

Performance issues, complaints, or nonconformances involving a supplier are raised as NCs in the Nonconformance Register. Serious or persistent performance failures may result in supplier suspension or removal from the Approved Supplier Register.

#### 5. CONTRACTOR HEALTH AND SAFETY

All contractors engaged by Overleaf Publishers Ltd are required to: provide evidence of appropriate public liability and professional indemnity insurance before commencement; confirm their competence for the specific work; adhere to the organisation's Health, Safety & Wellbeing Policy during their engagement; and report any incident, near-miss, or unsafe condition identified during their engagement.

#### 6. CONTRACTOR INFORMATION SECURITY

Contractors with access to the organisation's systems, data, or learner records are required to: sign a confidentiality and data processing agreement before commencing work; comply with the Information Security Policy and Access Control Policy; report any suspected security incident immediately; and return or securely destroy all data on contract termination.

#### 7. APPROVED SUPPLIER REGISTER

The Approved Supplier Register is maintained by the Director and contains: supplier name; services provided; risk category; approval date; insurance expiry; review date; and performance notes. The Register is reviewed at least annually and at each management review. Suppliers not reviewed within their required review cycle are suspended pending re-evaluation.

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